FREE PRINTABLE

IEP Meeting Prep Kit

A 2-week countdown checklist, 24 questions to ask, and a one-page script with an opening statement and phrases for the moments that go off track.



From the IEP Parent Binder & Tracker by Redraft Studio

Not legal advice. An organizing tool for parents. IEP rules vary by state.

Meeting countdown

Meeting date: _____ Time: _____ Place / link: _____

2 weeks before

- [ ] Ask for a draft IEP, any new evaluation report and recent data so you can read them before the meeting
- [ ] Confirm the date, time, place and who will attend
- [ ] Re-read the current IEP and your Progress pages
- [ ] Start your Top 3 concerns worksheet

1 week before

- [ ] Ask your child what's going well and what's hard (use the child snapshot page)
- [ ] Pick the 3 questions that matter most from the question bank
- [ ] Gather work samples and your home notes
- [ ] Tell the team if someone will come with you

The day before

- [ ] Print your one-page meeting script
- [ ] Put the IEP, Top 3 page, notes page and a pen in the binder
- [ ] Plan childcare and travel so you're not rushed
- [ ] Write down the one thing you most want to leave with

On the day

- [ ] Arrive a few minutes early
- [ ] Use the opening statement on your script
- [ ] Write each decision down as it's made, with who and by when
- [ ] Ask for a copy of anything you're asked to sign before you sign it
- [ ] Before leaving, ask when you'll get the notes and the new IEP

Bringing someone? A partner, relative or friend can take notes while you talk. Let the team know ahead of time.

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Question bank

Circle the 3-5 that matter most for this meeting. You won't have time for all of them.

Progress

1. What data did you collect on each goal, and how often?
2. Can I see the graphs or data sheets, not only the summary?
3. Which goals are on track to be met by the end of this IEP?
4. For a goal that has stalled, what will change in how it's taught?
5. How does my child's progress compare with the baseline in the IEP?
6. What does this goal look like when it's met? Can you give an example?
7. How will I hear about progress between report periods?
8. What can we work on at home that supports this goal?

Services

1. Who provides each service, and in what setting?
2. How are sessions logged, and can I see the log?
3. What happens when a session is missed: illness, holidays, staff absence?
4. How will missed sessions be made up, and when?
5. Is the service one-to-one or in a group? How big is the group?
6. Are services pulled out of class? Which subjects does my child miss?
7. Who do I contact if a provider leaves or changes?
8. Do the minutes still match what my child needs right now?

Accommodations

1. Which accommodations is my child using, and in which classes?
2. How do all teachers, including substitutes, know about the accommodations?
3. Are accommodations used on classroom tests as well as state tests?
4. Which accommodations aren't helping, and why?
5. Does my child know how to ask for an accommodation?
6. Is there anything my child is refusing to use? What would help?
7. Can we try a new accommodation and check back in 6 weeks?
8. How are accommodations handled on field trips and at lunch or recess?

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One-page meeting script

Print this and keep it on top of your binder in the meeting. It's fine to read from it.

Opening statement

Thank you all for being here. I want to start by saying what's going well: _____. My three main concerns today are: one, _____; two, _____; and three, _____. I'd like to leave today with a clear plan for each one, including who will do what and by when.

Useful phrases

To slow things down	"Can we pause for a moment? I'd like to write that down."
To understand	"Can you show me the data that supports that?"
To get specifics	"What will that look like in the classroom, and how often?"
To capture a decision	"So we've agreed to ___. Who is doing that, and by when?"
When you disagree	"I see this differently. Can we note my concern in the meeting notes?"
When you need time	"I'd like to take this home and read it before I sign. When do you need it back?"
When time runs out	"We haven't covered ___. Can we schedule a follow-up meeting?"
To close	"Can you send me today's notes and the next steps in writing?"

Before you leave, make sure you know:

- [ ] What was decided, and who does what by when
- [ ] When you'll get the notes and the IEP
- [ ] Who your main contact is
- [ ] When the team will check in again

You can ask for a short break at any point. You don't have to sign anything at the meeting if you want time to read it.

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